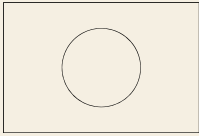


A REGISTER OF COLORS · TEN SPECIMENS

For approval before the other 185 entries are written. Each entry follows the same pattern:

1. Background or overall layout first.
2. Then stripes or blocks, in the order you read them: left to right, top to bottom.
3. Then the emblem, from the biggest part to the smallest.
4. Directions are always as you look at the page: left, right, top, bottom, middle.



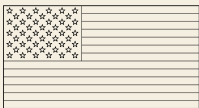
JAPAN A WHITE flag with one RED circle in the exact middle.

Why this one: The simplest case: one shape on a plain field. Sets the shortest entry length. (53 characters)



EGYPT Three equal stripes, top to bottom: RED, WHITE, BLACK. In the middle of the white stripe stands a GOLD eagle looking to your left. On its chest is a small shield with upright stripes, left to right: RED, WHITE, BLACK. Its claws hold a GOLD ribbon with the country's name in Arabic.

Why this one: Stripes plus an emblem inside a stripe; the emblem has its own small stripes, the opposite way round. (281 characters)



UNITED STATES Thirteen stripes, top to bottom, starting and ending with RED: seven RED and six WHITE, taking turns. In the top left corner, a BLUE rectangle as tall as the top seven stripes, holding 50 small WHITE stars in nine rows of six and five, taking turns.

Why this one: Counting: 13 stripes and 50 stars in alternating rows. Tests numbers in plain language. (249 characters)



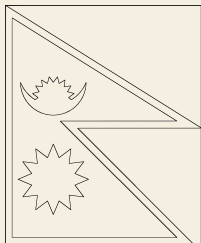
BRAZIL GREEN, with a large YELLOW diamond. Inside the diamond, a BLUE circle crossed by a curved WHITE band, higher on the left than on the right, with the words ORDEM E PROGRESSO in GREEN. Twenty-seven small WHITE stars: one above the band, all the others below it.

Why this one: Shapes nested inside each other, a curved band with lettering, and stars of different sizes. (259 characters)



BELIZE ROYAL BLUE, with a narrow RED stripe along the top and the bottom. In the middle, a WHITE circle ringed by 50 GREEN leaves. Inside: a shield with tools in its two upper parts and, below, a sailing ship on a DARK BLUE sea under a LIGHT BLUE sky. Two shirtless men in WHITE trousers stand beside it, the left one holding an axe, the right one a paddle. A GREEN mahogany tree rises above, and a scroll below reads SUB UMBRA FLOREO.

Why this one: The most detailed flag in the book: a full coat of arms with people. Tests the upper limit of entry length. (428 characters)



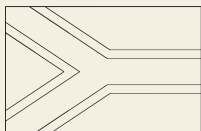
NEPAL Not a rectangle: two triangles stacked one on the other, the top one smaller, both pointing to your right. **CRIMSON** inside, with a **BLUE** border all the way around. In the top triangle, a **WHITE** crescent moon lying on its back, with eight short rays rising from it; in the bottom triangle, a **WHITE** sun with twelve points.

Why this one: The only flag that is not a rectangle. Tests describing shape before color. (317 characters)



BHUTAN Split by a straight line from the bottom left corner to the top right corner: the top half **YELLOW**, the bottom half **ORANGE**. Across the line lies a **WHITE** dragon facing right, holding a jewel in each claw.

Why this one: A diagonal division plus a large, intricate animal crossing the dividing line. (202 characters)



SOUTH AFRICA A **GREEN** band shaped like a Y lying on its side: its two arms start at the left corners, meet in the middle and run on as one band to the right edge. The Y has thin **WHITE** edges on its outer sides and a thin **GOLD** edge on the inside. Inside the Y, on the left, a **BLACK** triangle. Above the Y, **RED**; below it, **BLUE**.

Why this one: Six colors, thin edging bands and a sideways Y. Tests describing narrow borders without flag terms. (309 characters)



SRI LANKA A **GOLD** border runs around the flag and also splits it into two parts. On the left, two upright stripes: **GREEN**, then **ORANGE**. On the right, a large **MAROON** panel with a **GOLD** lion facing left, a sword raised in its front paw, and a **GOLD** leaf in each corner.

Why this one: A frame that also divides the flag, two panels, and a figure with small corner details. (253 characters)



SAUDI ARABIA **GREEN**. Across the upper middle runs a line of **WHITE** Arabic writing, the declaration of faith; beneath it lies a **WHITE** sword pointing to your left.

Why this one: An inscription. Tests how we describe writing the reader should not alter. (146 characters)